Who We Are

One Teacher, all siblings, and learning to listen

BIG IDEA

Christ is the one Teacher. The rest of us, believers and skeptics alike, are siblings. People who know they aren't the Teacher listen differently: firm on Christ, open to reason on a hundred other things.

OPENING

For your own good

Think of a time someone told you something "for your own good" and it didn't land. What made it hard to hear?

WHO WE ARE · 1

One Teacher, all siblings

Matthew 23:8–12

Matthew 23:15

Hebrews 2:11

LISTEN

Gone off debates

Why This Oxford Mathematician is Confident God Exists

Alex O'Connor and John Lennox · Alex O'Connor · 1:25:14–1:28:02

Later in the same conversation we heard last week, skeptic Alex O'Connor and John Lennox compare notes on public debates.

LISTEN FOR

- What Lennox says goes wrong in a debate
- What he wants instead, and what he trusts the audience to do

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3gKCwldMZS8&t=5114s

Scan to watch

WHO WE ARE · 2

So much to tell?

Romans 2:17–21

1 Corinthians 4:7

1 Corinthians 8:1–2

Luke 18:9–14

WHO WE ARE · 3

Wisdom that listens

James 3:1

James 3:13–18

James 1:19

Proverbs 18:13, 17

LISTEN

“I’ve got a long ways to go”

Breaking Down Walls: A Christian and an Atheist in Conversation

Sean McDowell · 1:01:48–1:02:54

Later in the conversation we heard last week, apologist Sean McDowell responds to atheist Drew’s criticism of how he has portrayed atheists to his students.

LISTEN FOR

- The proverb McDowell quotes, and why he applies it to himself
- What he admits

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VJX28I54YxE&t=3708s

Scan to watch

LISTEN

“I’m going to go back and think”

Alex O’Connor & Glen Scrivener: Morality, Freedom, Slavery & the Bible (Uncommon Ground)

Alex O’Connor and Glen Scrivener · Justin Brierley · 2:27:02–2:30:23

Last week we heard Glen Scrivener before his debate with Alex O’Connor. This is the end of it, two and a half hours later. Each thanks the other.

Scan to watch

LISTEN FOR

- What O’Connor thanks Scrivener for
- What Scrivener says he’s going to go home and do

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-ZnVNM8lkGw&t=8822s

WHO WE ARE · 4

The Teacher asks

Mark 10:46–52

Mark 7:24–30

Talk it over

1. Firm on Christ, open to reason on a hundred other things. Would the skeptic you know say you’re open to reason about anything? What might they name?

2. Last week Schaeffer said, “I must not push any further than I need to.” How does remembering that you’re a sibling, not the Teacher, change how hard you push?

3. What could you learn from the person you named last week?

The not-teacher

None of this means we stop teaching. Jesus didn't abolish teachers in Matthew 23. He moved every one of us into the ranks of the siblings, under the one Teacher who is the Christ. We still have something to tell: the best news there is. But we didn't invent it, we didn't earn it, and we haven't finished learning it (1 Corinthians 4:7).

Skeptics can tell the difference between someone who is selling and someone who is sharing. Be firm on Christ. Be open to reason about almost everything else. Ask real questions, and listen to the whole answer. We all might learn something.

THIS WEEK

Practice

1. Pray again, by name, for the person you thought of last week.
2. Ask them one real question, one you don't already know the answer to, and listen to the whole answer.
3. Notice one thing you could learn from them. Thank God for it.

Watch the clips and see every lesson online:
honortheskeptic.stlctrufant.com
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